

PUNAURA DHAM

BIHAR'S MONUMENT TO DIVINITY AND CULTURAL RENAISSANCE

"Janaki, the daughter of the earth, emerged pure and radiant from the furrow—her birth sanctified by the gods, her virtues destined to uplift the world."
— Ramayana

Rekindling an Epic: The Birthplace of Mata Sita

In the serene plains of Sitamarhi, northern Bihar, where the earth resonates itself with ancient tales, a transformation of profound significance is underway. This is the sacred land where Mata Sita, daughter of the Earth first emerged: a symbol of virtue, courage, and devotion. Punaura Dham, her revered birthplace, has long drawn pilgrims, scholars, and devotees. Today, it is being meticulously revived, evolving not merely into a temple, but into a living testament of faith, culture, and national pride. It is a place where history, spirituality, and art converge—a space where stone and story unite to narrate Sita's life, trials, and triumphs. The initiative underscores Bihar's commitment to honoring its mythic heritage and presenting it on a stage deserving of national and global recognition.

Laying the Cornerstone: A Historic Ceremony

On August 8th, a historic milestone marked the dawn of this ambitious vision. The foundation stone for Punaura Dham's grand temple complex was laid in a ceremony attended by Home Minister and Co-operative Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, whose presence emphasized the temple's importance as a spiritual landmark and cultural emblem for India. The event stirred excitement across the country and beyond, signaling that Sitamarhi's sacred ground would soon become a hub of global pilgrimage, scholarship, and cultural dialogue. The laying of the cornerstone was not only the start of construction but also a symbolic affirmation of Bihar's aspiration to revive its spiritual and cultural legacy.

Vision and Scale: A Dream Forged in Stone

The temple complex is being developed over a 67-acre sacred site in Sitamarhi district, with a total investment of $100 million (₹882 crore) and a targeted completion within 42 months. Bihar's Department of Tourism, in collaboration with renowned temple architects and cultural scholars, is ensuring that every detail—architectural, artistic, and spiritual—reflects the divine journey of Sita. The project aims to offer visitors an immersive experience that marries devotion, education, and cultural pride, presenting Sita's life in a manner both monumental and deeply personal.



Architectural Grandeur

Modeled on the magnificence of Ayodhya's Ram Mandir, the Central Grand Temple will form the heart of the complex, narrating Mata Sita's journey in stone, sculpture, and mural. Exquisitely carved reliefs, monumental statues, and murals depicting key events from the Ramayana will offer pilgrims a profoundly immersive spiritual experience. Surrounding the central sanctum, six shrine pavilions will portray critical moments from Sita's life—from her birth and marriage to her exile and trials—creating a narrative journey that highlights her courage, virtue, and resilience. Every element has been carefully designed, reflecting Sita's dignity and the cultural ethos of Mithila and northern India. The temple serves as a custodian of heritage, bridging myth, history, and devotion in one living monument.

A Living Centerpiece: Celebrating Sita's Legacy

Punaura Dham is envisioned as more than a spiritual destination; it is a cultural and educational hub. The Ramayana Gallery and Museum will house rare manuscripts, digital archives, and 3D exhibits, offering scholars, devotees, and students interactive experiences that explore the epic's history and philosophy. Immersive storytelling zones